

Optical Drives

Authoring Software

Used for the creation of a database for a CD. Authoring usually results in a search-and-retrieval type of document, with the addition of a user interface. Authoring functions include tagging and indexing.

Buffer Underrun

An error where the data stream being fed from the CD's cache buffer falls behind the laser that is doing the writing.

CD

Compact Disc. A digital medium made of a polycarbonate substrate, a reflective metalised layer, and a protective lacquer coating. Recordable CDs also have an organic dye data layer between the substrate and the metal reflective layer.

CD-ROM

Compact Disc Read Only Memory. The compact disc format that is used to hold text, graphics and hi-fi stereo sound. The disk is almost the same as the music CD, but uses different tracks for data. The music CD player cannot play CD-ROMs, but most CD-ROM players are able to play CDs. A CD-ROM can hold 650 MB of data, which is equivalent to about 250,000 pages of text or 20,000 medium-resolution images.

CD-RW

Rewritable CDs; CDs that can be written and erased many times, unlike CDR (CD read only) disks that can only be written on once.

Codec

Short for compressor/decompressor, a codec is any technology for compressing and decompressing data. Codecs can be implemented in software, hardware, or a combination of both. Some popular codecs for computer video include MPEG, Indeo and Cinepak.